

How to Create Realistic AI Voices (That Don't Sound Like Trash)

The Three Tools You Actually Need

When it comes to creating realistic AI voices, you don't need a dozen different tools. You need three specific ones, each serving a distinct purpose. These tools will help you generate voices that sound natural, human, and authentic—not robotic or overly polished.

The key is understanding what each tool does best and when to use it. Let's break down the three essential tools you need in your arsenal.

Tool #1: MiniMax (For Text-to-Speech)

MiniMax has the most realistic voices out of any tool right now. Period.

It's got this text-to-speech model that's just... different. The realism, the cadence—it all feels natural.

Pricing:

- Free plan gives you decent credits (honestly might be all you need)
- Paid plan is only $5/month for 120 minutes
- Pretty hard to beat

Why MiniMax excels:

The cadence. The natural flow. When you're doing B-rolls or you need an actor to keep talking, you need voices that sound like actual people. Not announcers. Not studio quality. Real room presence.

And if you're doing organic content or AI influencers, you need voices that sound like they're coming from a real space, not a professional recording booth.

How to Use MiniMax

Option 1: Use Pre-Made Voices

1. Log in (free account works fine)
2. Go to Text to Speech
3. Pick from their library of voices
4. Generate

Simple.

Option 2: Create Your Own Voice (This is where it gets good)

You've got two ways to do this:

Voice Design:

- Create a custom prompt using Claude or ChatGPT
- Build your own voice from scratch
- Describe exactly what you want

Voice Clone:

- Upload a 10 second audio clip
- MiniMax recreates that voice using their tech
- Use it for all your text-to-speech

Pro tip: You can also upload any voice audio and isolate background noise. Great for cleaning up samples before training.

What MiniMax Voices Sound Like:

> The voice is very realistic. It actually feels like it's in a room talking, not coming through a studio mic with perfect acoustics. When it's too polished, it's not really realistic. That's the difference we're going for here.

Tool #2: ElevenLabs (For Text-to-Speech ONLY)

ElevenLabs can work well, but only for one specific use case: text-to-speech.

CRITICAL: Do NOT use ElevenLabs for speech-to-speech or voice changing. It will ruin your voice quality.

The Right Way to Use ElevenLabs

The pre-made voices in ElevenLabs don't work for realistic UGC. They sound too generic, too polished.

The only way to get realistic ElevenLabs voices:

Create your own voices using either:

1. ElevenLabs Voice Design
2. ElevenLabs Voice Clone with your own audio input

When you create custom voices this way, the output is much more realistic and natural.

Creating a Custom ElevenLabs Voice

01

Generate the Voice Design Prompt

Use Gemini to create your voice design prompt.

1. Upload a photo of your AI character
2. Prompt: "Give me an ElevenLabs voice design prompt to create a voice for an AI character that looks like this. Make sure the voice sounds like it's in the actual room."

The "in the actual room" part is critical. We don't want podcast quality or polished studio sound. That kills realism.

02

Use Voice Design in ElevenLabs

1. Take the prompt Gemini generated
2. Paste it into ElevenLabs Voice Design
3. ElevenLabs will generate 3 different voice options
4. Pick the best one (usually at least 1 or 2 are good quality)

03

Use for Text-to-Speech Only

Once you have your custom voice, use it exclusively for text-to-speech generation.

Never use ElevenLabs speech-to-speech or voice changer features. They degrade quality significantly.

Tool #3: Resemble AI (For Voice Enhancement & Changing)

Here's the thing, you might already have an AI video you made. Maybe you used a different tool, or maybe the voice just doesn't sound realistic enough.

That's where Resemble AI comes in.

What makes it special:

It uses open source models called Chatterbox and Chatterbox Turbo. These are significantly better than ElevenLabs' speech-to-speech and voice changer features.

They also have their own text-to-speech model. It's very realistic and definitely much more realistic than ElevenLabs when used for voice changing. I'd say it's second to MiniMax—MiniMax still has better cadence and quality, but Resemble is a solid option if you want to use open source models.

How to Use Resemble AI

The Voice Changer Feature (This is the main use case):

Let's say you already have a video, maybe from Veo 3, Sora 2, or any other AI video tool. The problem is those static, robotic AI voices don't sound realistic. They're too clean, too artificial.

You can take that voice, extract it, and put it into Resemble AI. It'll change the voice to a more enhanced, realistic version. Much more natural sounding.

Here's how:

1. Upload your existing AI video audio
2. Pick a target voice from their library that sounds more realistic
3. Generate

The voice gets transformed into something that actually sounds human.

Creating Custom Voices:

You've also got options to build your own:

Design a Voice:

- Use a text prompt to describe what you want
- Let the AI generate it

Clone a Voice:

Two methods here:

Rapid Voice Clone (recommended for most people)

- Fast model
- Quality is basically identical to Professional
- No real difference in testing

Professional Voice Clone

- Upload 3 to 30 minutes of audio
- Takes about an hour to process
- Extremely accurate
- Overkill for most use cases

Honestly, stick with Rapid. It's faster and the quality's the same, sometimes even better.

The Complete Workflow

Here's how to put it all together:

For New Voiceovers:

1 → 2 → 3

Step 1

Create your script

Step 2

Generate voice in MiniMax or ElevenLabs (custom voice only)

- Use pre-made voice, OR
- Clone your own voice, OR
- Design a custom voice

Step 3

Use in your UGC videos

For Fixing Existing AI Videos:

01 — Extract the audio from your existing AI video

02 — Upload it to Resemble AI

03 — Pick a more realistic target voice or create your own

04 — Generate the enhanced version

05 — Replace the audio in your video

That's it.

Tool Comparison Summary

MiniMax:

- Best overall for text-to-speech
- Most natural cadence and room presence
- Use as your primary voice generation tool

ElevenLabs:

- Good for text-to-speech when using custom voices only
- Never use pre-made voices
- Never use speech-to-speech or voice changer
- Create custom voices through Voice Design or Voice Clone

Resemble AI:

- Best for voice changing and enhancement
- Use to fix existing AI video audio
- Great for transforming robotic voices into natural ones
- Superior speech-to-speech compared to ElevenLabs

Why This Matters

When your AI voices sound too polished, people notice. Their guard goes up. They disengage.

But when your voices sound like they're coming from a real person in a real room, that's when the magic happens.

MiniMax, properly configured ElevenLabs, and Resemble AI give you that realism.

Simple as that.